

EPISODE ONE CANDIDATE

NO FIXED ADDRESS, v2.1

Supersedes v1.0. · v2.1 revision 2026-08-26: ruling question 1 ANSWERED by Stephen and the premise's largest exposure is closed. · 2026-08-26 · v1.0 verdict PASS is WITHDRAWN. All six findings of the independent REWORK review are accepted without contest and repaired below. Nothing is deferred to Mode B.

What changed, in one line each.

#	Finding	Repair
1	Identification failure was asserted, not demonstrated; misadventure unexplained	Cause of death written; every identification route answered individually; the load-bearing gap ruled into canon as R16 (v2.1)
2	Dean's proactive helpfulness irrational while she is unnamed	Phase change stated. He is silent until identification becomes likely
3	Three of four decisions were outlines; lead arithmetic contradictory	Four decisions demonstrated with corrected arithmetic and a fairness test each
4	Relocation test run against a district, not a city	Re-run against another city. Dependency moved onto canon that does not travel
5	Next-of-kin obstacle was rhetoric promoted to canon; access map circular	Claim withdrawn. Reconstruction moved entirely off the body
6	Nothing worsening before Ally arrives; the clock was not a clock	Case-born clock that is already running when the episode opens

1. THE CRIME, AND WHAT THE BODY SHOWED

Kerry Nolan, thirty-four, left Dean Iles in September and moved without telling him. She rented a room in Rivermouth and took a night cleaning shift at the Hart Civic Center. She made no complaint and sought no order against him. **She simply left, which is why there is no legal document anywhere connecting her new life to his name.**

In November her sister-in-law posted a photograph with a recognisable window behind it. He found her in nine days. He went to make her talk to him. She backed away, he took hold of her, she went down and struck her head once on the corner of the hearth.

Cause of death: a single blunt impact to the back of the skull. No defensive injuries. No ligature. No weapon.

He sat in his van for two hours. Then he drove her to the foot of the embankment steps below the Stonebridge Viaduct and left her there.

Why misadventure is a competent finding. A single impact head injury on a woman found at the foot of a flight of wet concrete steps in November is exactly what a fall down those steps produces. The pathology is unremarkable and the scene explains it. **The autopsy is not wrong and the coroner is not lazy.** The same injury on a woman found on her own hearth would have been looked at very differently, and that is the whole point: **the pathology is identical and the inference is not.** That is unequal looking, and it is the episode's mechanism rather than its excuse.

2. WHY SHE IS STILL UNIDENTIFIED, ROUTE BY ROUTE

The v1.0 claim that "nothing existed to make the records meet" was too absolute and contradicted its own normal-response row. Each route is now answered.

Route	Why it produced nothing
Fingerprints	Taken post-mortem and searched correctly. Kerry has no criminal record and never held a role requiring printing, so she is not on file . A correct search of a database she was never in returns nothing
Dental	Odontology is confirmatory, not searching . It compares a body to a named candidate. Until a candidate exists there is nothing to compare against. This is true of real practice and is not a shortcut
DNA	Requires a reference sample. The only available reference is her mother, and no reference was ever taken from Maureen , for the reason in the next row
The interstate report's classification	★ The load-bearing repair . Kerry was reported by her mother as an adult who had moved interstate, changed jobs, and cut contact after leaving a partner. That is correctly classified low-risk, voluntarily absent . Low-risk adult reports do not attract biometric reference collection, because nobody believes the person is dead. Nobody thought Kerry needed finding. They thought she had left . So there was never anything on Kerry's side of the comparison to match against
Physical description	Compared and produced candidates. She was among them. A description match is not an identification , it is a list, and a list of possible thirty-to-forty-five-year-old women requires biometric or family follow-up to resolve. See the ruling question below
Automated cross-jurisdictional matching	★ ANSWERED. Bible §2.3.2 R16, Stephen-ruled 2026-08-26: participation is VOLUNTARY AND PATCHY . Ruled from real-world practice, not from what this premise needed. Kerry's record may or may not have been entered; either way entry is not identification , and the candidate list it produces cannot be resolved without the reference sample nobody took

The stay-away condition of v1.0 is deleted. The reviewer correctly identified it as an unexplained link between Kerry's legal identity and Dean. She never made a complaint. Nothing on paper joins them.

What this costs Maureen, and it is the theme. The classification that said *she has probably just left* is the same classification that meant nobody took her mother's DNA. The system was not wrong about the risk. It was wrong about Kerry, and it was wrong in the direction that costs nothing to be wrong in.

3. ANTAGONIST, WITH THE PHASE CHANGE STATED

Why murder. He did not go to kill her. The killing is the failure of a visit he should not have made, which is what the overwhelming majority of these deaths are.

Why the steps. He needed a place where a head injury explains itself and where the person is presumed to be someone nobody is looking for. **The steps do both jobs**, which is why they are worth a twenty-minute drive and the risk of the van. This is now testable because the cause of death is written.

PHASE ONE, leads 1 to 11: Dean does nothing. While Kerry is unidentified he is invisible, and every action he could take would make him less so. He does not contact Maureen. He does not contact Ally. **The reviewer was right that v1.0's proactive helpfulness was irrational, and it is deleted.**

PHASE TWO, from the lead where identification becomes likely: Ally reaches him, because he is named in Maureen's report as the last partner. **Now cooperation is his cheapest option:** refusing would draw the attention that silence used to buy. He is warm, volunteers small true things, and manages what Ally believes about him.

PHASE THREE, only if the player publishes early: now that Kerry has a name, control of the story is cheaper than absence, and he contacts Maureen himself. **This is a consequence of a player choice, not a character trait**, and it is unreachable on the other branch.

4. ACCESS MAP, CIRCLE BROKEN

v1.0's bug: the bus pass was on the body, the effects were inaccessible until identification, and the bus pass was the identification spine. That loop never closed.

Repair: nothing decisive is on the body. The reconstruction runs entirely on material Ally can lawfully reach by owner consent.

Item	Lawful possessor	Route
The missing-person report and its photograph	Maureen Nolan, as the reporting person	She gives Ally her own copy
The bag of Kerry's things from the re-let room	The landlord, holding a former tenant's property	He hands it over, or the new tenant does. This is the spine
The bus pass, topped up and not carried	In that bag, in a drawer	Same route
Her absence from work	A night supervisor at the Hart Civic Center	He noticed and said nothing, because people leave those shifts without notice
The mural record of that night	Nova Skye	Her consent, at a price. See Decision 1

What remains inaccessible: the coronial file, the post-mortem, the effects held with the body. **Ally never needs them.**

Withdrawn claim. "You cannot be next of kin to a person with no name" was rhetoric and is deleted. §2.3.2 R5 does not say it. Maureen is Kerry's mother throughout. **How a coroner verifies a claimed relationship to an unidentified deceased is a ruling question, not a settled obstacle**, and it is asked in §7 rather than asserted.

What Ally gets wrong because she can reach only part of the record. Maureen's report names Dean as a contact, because in November she still believed her daughter was with him. **Ally meets him as the last person who loved Kerry, and the document that makes her trust him is the same document that breaks the case.**

5. THE CLOCK, AND WHAT IS WORSENING BEFORE ALLY ARRIVES

v1.0 had no clock. Preserved effects are not decaying and a phone account lapses at its payer's discretion.

Repair. The room has been re-let. Kerry's belongings are in a bag in the landlord's cupboard and **he clears the cupboard when the next tenancy turns over.** The date exists before Ally hears about the case and does not move because of anything she does.

This is the live injustice, and it is running when the episode opens. The last physical trace of who Kerry was is going into a skip this month, and after that the only remaining route to her name is a DNA reference nobody has thought to ask her mother for. Day-stamped, case-born, pause-safe, and **not the same object as the resistance.**

6. AGENCY: FOUR DECISIONS, DEMONSTRATED

Two Class A, two Class B, no Class C. Arithmetic corrected: every branch rejoins within three leads of its fork, and no fork opens before its branch rejoins.

Decision 1 • lead 4 • Class A • rejoins lead 7

Nova Skye's murals under the viaduct encode movement and warnings. Ally wants that night read.

- **Branch A, use it.** Ally gets the van on the service road at the right hour. **Nova's code is burned the moment it is spoken about publicly, and the camps lose the warning system they rely on.** Bram is picked up in a sweep at lead 7 and the player watches it.
- **Branch B, refuse it.** The van is never recovered. Ally reaches the same district at lead 7 through the work supervisor instead, without the vehicle.

Material loss: Nova loses the code, which she held and made and which cannot be rebuilt inside the episode. The player sees a mural painted over.

Decision 2 • lead 6 • Class B • rejoins lead 8

The bag of Kerry's things is in the landlord's cupboard and the cupboard is being cleared.

- **Branch A, ask him directly.** The bag arrives intact and fast. He now knows someone is asking, and empties the rest of the room that week rather than be involved.
- **Branch B, go through the new tenant.** The room stays intact three leads longer. **If the landlord learns, her tenancy ends**, and she has nowhere else.

Decision 3 · lead 9 · Class A · rejoins lead 12

Ally has a probable name and no proof.

- **Branch A, tell Maureen now.** She flies in, gives the DNA reference nobody ever asked for, and identification moves weeks. **She also tells her sister, her employer and her church before it is confirmed, and none of that can be untold if Ally is wrong.**
- **Branch B, wait.** An officer reaches Maureen at lead 12 and she understands Ally already knew. **She declines to appear**, and Kerry is named without her mother's voice in the episode.

Decision 4 · lead 14 · Class B · rejoins at the close

Publish the name before or after the record is amended.

- **Branch A, publish first.** Kerry's name reaches the people who knew her and two workmates come forward. **Dean learns exactly what Ally holds and reaches Maureen within a day**, which is Phase Three above.
- **Branch B, wait for the amendment.** Dean gets no warning. **Kerry stays a file number for another three weeks and Maureen cannot bury her.**

Fairness test, all four

	What the player knows	Risk each way	Why either is reasonable	Later reframe	Cannot be undone
1	The camps saw something; Nova is unwilling and has said why	A: a named woman's work is destroyed. B: the vehicle is lost	A buys the only physical thread. B refuses to spend someone else's safety on it	The supervisor route reaches the same district anyway, which the player cannot know at lead 4	The code, and Bram's place
2	The cupboard is being cleared; the date is real	A: the room is stripped early. B: a tenancy ends	A secures the spine now. B preserves more for longer	Two items that mattered were still in the room, not the bag	The contents of the room, or the tenancy
3	A probable name, no proof, and a mother still ringing a phone	A: a mother is told on a guess and tells everyone. B: she hears it from a stranger	A can save weeks and give the reference. B refuses to gamble with a mother's certainty	The name is right, which the player cannot know at lead 9	What Maureen told her family, or her trust in Ally
4	The name is confirmed; the record is not yet amended	A: the antagonist is warned. B: three more weeks as a number	A gives Kerry back to the people who knew her. B protects the case	Dean was already preparing to reach Maureen	Dean's warning, or the delay to the funeral

Counterfactual. Remove the player's decisions and Nova keeps her code, Bram keeps his place, the room is cleared on schedule, Maureen hears from an officer, and Kerry is named weeks later without her mother's voice. **Named people's outcomes change.**

D9. Decision 1's protective branch does not merely delay: it permanently costs the investigation the van. Decision 2's protective branch costs a named tenant her housing. Neither is a wait.

7. HAVENBAY NECESSITY, RELOCATION TESTED AGAINST ANOTHER CITY

v1.0 failed this by relocating to a different Havenbay district. The correct test moves the whole case to another port city with an underpass camp and unequal institutional attention.

Under that test, the following survive relocation and are therefore **not** claimed as necessity: the viaduct, the camps, the unequal priority, the transit system, the districts.

What does not survive: Nova Skye's coded murals. Canon establishes her as a street artist and activist whose murals under the Stonebridge Viaduct carry codes, and that Ally reads those codes as escape routes. **That is a community-maintained visual record of movement, made by a named canon character, existing because of what Havenbay's under-bridge population is escaping.** It is the only route to the vehicle. Relocate the case and there is no code, no Nova, and no recoverable record of who passed under that bridge at night. Decision 1 ceases to exist, the strongest branch in the episode goes with it, and the reconstruction loses its only physical thread.

Recorded honestly: this is the weakest of the six repairs. The murals are canon rather than physics, so the necessity rests on the canon being real rather than on the world being unable to work otherwise. I would rather state that than dress it up.

8. PROCESS DEPENDENCIES

Answered by canon (§2.3.2): coronial findings and tendered evidence to next of kin, notes closed · weather and visibility permanent and public · CCTV thirty-one days, so **the van is outside the window and the reconstruction does not use traffic footage.**

PENDING APPROVAL. Four one-line rulings, asked rather than invented:

1. ~~Does Havenbay operate mandatory and complete cross-jurisdictional matching?~~ ★ **RULED 2026-08-26: voluntary and patchy. Bible §2.3.2 R16.** No longer pending.
2. How does a Havenbay coroner verify a claimed relationship to an unidentified deceased, and what may a proposed relative do before identification is formal?
3. Who may formally identify a deceased person, and what happens when a family in another jurisdiction comes forward?
4. Can a finding of misadventure be amended once the deceased is identified, and by whom?

Small-number test: NOT DECISIVE. Nothing turns on a time, distance or measurement.

9. KILL BRIEF

Competent professional. Every identification route is answered individually in §2 and none requires anyone to skip a step. The pathology is unremarkable and correct. The classification was right about the risk and wrong about Kerry. **The exposure that ruling question 1 represented is closed: R16 rules participation voluntary and patchy, checked against real practice rather than against what this premise wanted.**

Rational antagonist. Silent while she is unnamed, cooperative once he is reachable, and controlling the story only after a player choice makes that cheaper than absence. The staging is now testable against a written cause of death and it earns its twenty-minute drive.

Ordinary player. *A mother is ringing her dead daughter's phone because nobody has told her, and nobody has told her because everyone decided she had simply left.* No jargon, no proper noun, no trade term. Someone to be angry at, present from the lead where identification becomes likely.

Producer. Sixteen played leads, five canon locations, one new interior, three new portraits. The `requiresFlag` / `forbidsFlag` gate shipped and is tested. **Note: `LeadsBarView` hardcodes a twelve-lead counter and must be fixed before this ships.**

VERDICT: READY FOR THE SPOKEN TEST. NOT A PASS.

v1.0 claimed PASS while admitting performed compulsion was UNKNOWN and no cold open existed. The reviewer was right that the charter forbids that, and G2 forbids a conditional pass, so no pass is claimed. This document says only that the premise is now sound enough to spend an opening on and put in front of readers.

Three weaknesses recorded and not defended. A woman killed by a former partner is the most common real homicide and the most frequently told, so the freshness lives in the identity structure rather than the crime. The Gate 7 dependency rests on canon rather than physics. And the third weakness recorded in v2.0, that ruling question 1 could kill the premise, is now resolved rather than outstanding.